

Little Boy bomb		Fat Man bomb	
Target	Hiroshima (population 350 000)	Target	Originally: Kokura Due to cloud cover, the bomb was diverted to its second target, Nagasaki (population 240 000)
Diameter	71 cm	Diameter	1.52 m
Length	3 m	Length	3.25 m
Weight	4000 kg	Weight	4545 kg
Chemical	Uranium	Chemical	Plutonium implosion bomb
Design	Simple	Design	Complicated
Tested	No	Tested	Yes, in New Mexico only a few weeks earlier
Power	Equivalent to 13 kilotonnes of TNT	Power	Equivalent to 20 kilotonnes of TNT
Plane	B-29 bomber, piloted by Paul Tibbets and named <i>Enola Gay</i> after his mother	Plane	B-29 bomber named <i>Bockscar</i> , piloted by Major Charles Sweeney
Dropped	8.16 am on 6 August 1945	Dropped	11.02 am on 9 August 1945
Deaths	70 000 immediate deaths. As of August 2011, the official memorial in Hiroshima lists the names of 275 230 people who have died from the bomb or its effects (e.g. radiation poisoning).	Deaths	40 000 immediate deaths. More than 70 000 deaths within months. As of August 2011, the official memorial in Nagasaki lists the names of 155 546 people who have died from the bomb or its effects.

Source 2.34 Details of the Little Boy and Fat Man bombs

Activity 2.8

- 1
 - a Read the following arguments for and against the dropping of the bombs on Japan.
 - b Write down the points in each list that you think are the most powerful.
 - c Choose the point of view you agree with most.
- 2 Write an extended response to this statement: 'Discuss whether the Allies should have dropped the bombs on Japan. Use evidence to support your argument.'

Arguments FOR dropping the bombs

- It was a joint decision made by the United States in conjunction with the Allied nations.
- The Allies claimed that the bombs ended the war quickly, saving hundreds of thousands of lives that would have been lost if the war continued.
- In US President Truman's memoirs, he cited figures that 1.5 million Allied soldiers would be needed to invade Japan with expected losses of 500 000 men.
- Dutch van Kirk, the navigator of the *Enola Gay* bomber, said that 'it was not a war of our choosing. We were trying to end the war and end the killing ... It was an extremely hard, deadly way to do it but in the long run it really saved lives'.

Activity 2.8 continued

- The United States could not really adopt a 'soft' approach after all of the pain that the Japanese had inflicted during the war, such as at Pearl Harbor.
- The United States had the new atomic technology, so they had a right to use it.
- Japan had been so difficult to defeat because, for the sake of maintaining their honour, they would prefer to fight to the death than to surrender. Twelve thousand US lives had been lost through kamikaze attacks.
- Conventional bombing of Japanese cities had not forced the Japanese to surrender. Devastating atom bomb attacks might.
- All of the theories about the bombs ending the war worked: a week after the second bomb had been dropped on the city of Nagasaki, the Japanese Government surrendered to the Allies.

Arguments AGAINST dropping the bombs

- The moral argument is that innocent civilians, not the military servicemen, were the main victims.
- There was no likelihood of Japan winning the war at this stage in 1945.
- The blockade of Japan had reduced the Japanese people to near-starvation so it was likely that Japan would have surrendered anyway.
- Sixty Japanese cities had already been destroyed by conventional bombing. Japan was therefore already defenceless and nearly defeated.
- Russia had entered the war in the Asia-Pacific by attacking Japanese troops in Manchuria.
- Radiation blasts would lead to slow and agonising deaths. A quote from Hitoshi Takayama (15 years old at the time), who survived the Hiroshima bomb: 'I was with people who were terribly burned. Some were naked, some had the clothing burning into their skins. The skin was falling off their hands and faces like rags. It was hard to think of them as human'.
- A main alternative would have been for the United States to demonstrate the power of the bomb over the Tokyo Harbour rather than demolishing a city. Such a threatening warning may have resulted in surrender without deaths. A related alternative would have been to wait for surrender after the first bomb on Hiroshima and refrain from bombing Nagasaki.
- Former US President Eisenhower said in an interview with an American magazine in 1963 that 'it wasn't necessary to hit them with that awful thing. I hated to see our country to be the first to use such a weapon'.
- Gerard J. DeGroot, professor of modern history at the University of St Andrews, Scotland, said: 'The bomb is a weapon that reflects the flawed nature of human beings' understanding of each other, their craving for power and their obsession with big things. It was developed by scientists whose ... naive vision of the world convinced them that they were doing good'.